

**LISTENING**
#14**Teacher's Guide**

SCRIPT: TAXI RIDE

Passenger: Hey Taxi! Ah great. Thanks for pulling over.

Driver: Where to?

Passenger: Well, I'm going to the National Museum of Art, and . . .

Driver: Sure. Hop in. No problem. Hang on!

Passenger: Uh. Excuse me. How long does it take to get there?

Driver: Well, that all depends on the traffic, but it shouldn't take more than twenty minutes for the average driver. [*Oh.*] And I'm not average. I have driving down to an art, so we should be able to cruise through traffic and get there in less than twelve minutes.

Passenger: Okay. Uh, sorry for asking, [*Yeah?*] but do you have any idea how much the fare will be?

Driver: Oh, it shouldn't be more than 18 dollars . . . not including a . . . uh-hum . . . a tip of course.

Passenger: Oh, and by the way, do you know what time the museum closes?

Driver: Well, I would guess around 6:00 O'clock.

Passenger: Uh, do you have the time?

Driver: Yeah. It's half past four. [*Thanks.*] Uh, this is your first time to the city, right?

Passenger: Yeah. How did you know?

Driver: Well, you can tell tourists [from] a mile away in this city because they walk down the street looking straight up at the skyscrapers.

Passenger: Was it that obvious?

Driver: Well . . .

Passenger: Oh, before I forget, can you recommend any good restaurants downtown that offer meals at a reasonable price?

Driver: Umm . . . Well, the Mexican restaurant, La Fajita, is fantastic. [*Oh.*] It's not as inexpensive as other places I know, but the decor is very authentic, [*Okay.*] and the portions are larger than most places I've been to.

Passenger: Sounds great! How do I get there from the museum?

Driver: Well, you can catch the subway right outside the museum. There are buses that run that way, but you would have to transfer a couple of times. And there are taxis too, but they don't run by the museum that often.

Passenger: Okay. Thanks.

Answer Key

1. The passenger is going to the National Museum of Art.
2. It usually takes about 20 minutes.
3. Around 18 dollars.
4. The driver guesses the museum closes at around 6:00 o'clock.
5. c) He walks looking straight up at the skyscrapers.
6. The driver recommends a Mexican restaurant called *La Fajita*.
7. The decor is authentic and the portions are large.
8. c) Subway, bus, or taxi

Idioms

“Cruise through” = move easily or quickly through something.

“The driver said he could cruise through traffic and get there fast.”